1) For a given dimension of the generator, three-phase machine produces higher power output than a single-phase machine.
2) For the same capacity, three-phase alternator is smaller in size when compared to single-phase alternator.
3) Three-phase transmission system is cheaper. A relatively thinner wire is sufficient for transmission of three-phase power.

4.6 TRANSFORMER

Transformer is a stationary device used to transform electrical power from one circuit to another without changing its frequency. The applied alternating voltage is either increased or decreased with corresponding decrease or increase of current in the circuit.

If the transformer converts an alternating current with low voltage into an alternating current with high voltage, it is called **step-up transformer**. On the contrary, if the transformer converts alternating current with high voltage into an alternating current with low voltage, then it is called **step-down transformer**.

4.6.1 Construction and working of transformer

Principle

The principle of transformer is the mutual induction between two coils. That is, when an electric current passing through a coil changes with time, an emf is induced in the neighbouring coil.

Construction

In the simple construction of transformers, there are two coils of high mutual inductance wound over the same transformer core. The core is generally laminated and is made up of a good magnetic material like silicon steel. Coils are electrically insulated but magnetically linked via transformer core (Figure 4.32).

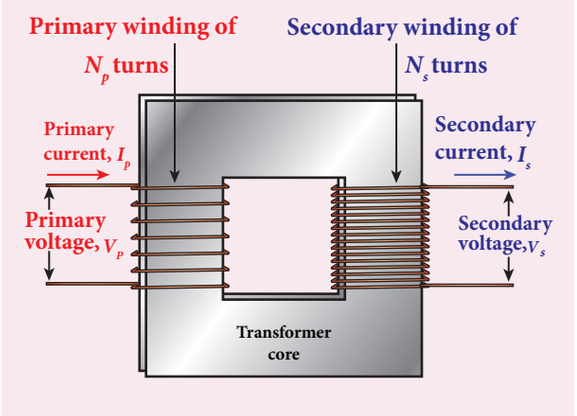


Figure 4.32(a) Construction of transformer



Figure 4.32(b) Roadside transformer

The coil across which alternating voltage is applied is called primary coil *P* and the coil from which output power is drawn out is called secondary coil *S*. The assembled core and coils are kept in a container which is filled with suitable medium for better insulation and cooling purpose.

Working

If the primary coil is connected to a source of alternating voltage, an alternating magnetic flux is set up in the laminated core. If there is no magnetic flux leakage, then whole of magnetic flux linked with primary coil is also linked with secondary

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